

SURREY SCOUT

MAY, 1977

No. 362

Cub Scouts

by: Derek Bassett

The Developed Arrow Training Programme

I hope that every Cub Scout Leader now has full details of the Developed Arrow Training Programme in the form of a copy of the handbook that was issued to Assistant District Commissioners (Cub Scouts) at the Regional Seminar held in January. The earliest date for the general introduction of the Developed Programme is September 1977 which will be the start of a two year transition period so that we all have plenty of time to prepare ourselves for the full implementation of these developments.

I, like most people, am always hesitant to change and when I first read of the developments in the Arrow Training Programme I was not immediately convinced of their benefits. However I must say that the more I hear of the Programme, the more I consider the thinking behind these developments; the more discussions I join in the more convinced I become that these developments are absolutely right for our section and I think the National Cub Scout Board is to be congratulated on the results of several years' labours. I hope that as Leaders become more familiar with the developments that they will become as enthusiastic as I am and to this end, it is very important that all Leaders seriously consider the thinking behind the Programme before becoming bogged down with details of the individual activities within the four training areas that now form the basis of the Arrow Training Programme. The District discussion meetings that I have been able to attend have been very stimulating and, as I expected, Surrey Cub Scout Leaders are ready to meet the challenges now before them. I hope that I will receive more invitations to join in future District discussion meetings but do however urge that we "make haste slowly" and do not rush into action until we have all the support material we require which Headquarters say should be ready by the end of the summer.

In my visits to Districts I have received several requests for help from the County Training Team in

assisting Districts with running skill training evenings with a special emphasis on programme planning within the Developed Arrow Scheme. The Training Team have indicated their willingness to assist us in this way but do feel that they should wait until the support material - or at least advance copies of it - are available so that we all move forward in the same direction. The plan is therefore to mount a series of skill training evenings throughout the autumn and I would be grateful if Districts would inform me of their needs in this respect as soon as possible so that we can plan our programmes accordingly.

Pack Camps and Pack Holidays

The main Pack camping and Pack holiday season will no doubt commence as usual at the end of May and I would therefore like to take this opportunity of wishing everyone a successful and very happy camping and holiday season. I would welcome the opportunity this year of visiting any Pack camps that are held within the County and would therefore be glad to receive details of these from those Leaders concerned.

Cub Scout Prayer Cards

Our existing stock of prayer cards is now almost exhausted and the County Cub Scout Sub-Committee have taken the decision to continue with these but possibly in a reprinted format. I would therefore appreciate comments from Leaders suggesting any alterations that they would like to see in the prayer card and following a suggestion made by Esher District, we would like to see on the new card some prayers included that have been composed by Cub Scouts. I will therefore present a book token to any Cub Scout who produces a prayer that is used in the new card, the selection for which will be made by the County Chaplains and myself. I would ask all Leaders to publicise this to their Cub Scouts and suggest a closing date of August 1st for the submission of prayers by Cub Scouts.

County Commissioner

"All premises, sites, vessels, aircraft, vehicles and other equipment in general public view or likely to be seen by the public must be maintained to a standard likely to reflect credit upon the Association".

On looking through the 1977 edition of P.O.R. - The Policy, Organisation and Rules of The Scout Association - which has just been revised and issued in two parts, it occurred to me that while we may not have any aircraft of our own in Surrey, we certainly have 250 Headquarters, which we either own or use, about 586 "vessels" of one sort or another including canoes and an increasing number of coaches, minibuses, vans and the like. Rule I 90 quoted above applies to all of these. In this the Queen's Silver Jubilee Year, when Scouting will be much in the public eye, we should all take a good look at our Headquarters buildings and their surrounds, our boats and vehicles to ensure that they do, in fact, reflect credit upon the Association.

By now the two booklets comprising the 1977 edition of P.O.R. should be available in each Group throughout the County. It is the responsibility of all G.S.L.s or Scouters in charge of Groups, just as much as of Commissioners and Administrators, to ensure that they and all warranted Leaders are familiar with the contents and, not least, actually comply with them!

In the Introduction to the 1977 edition, which is a considerable improvement upon earlier editions and much easier to read, it is stated:

"The Founder called the first set of rules 'Rules for playing the Game of Scouting', stressing at the outset that it was the practice of good Scouting that was important and not any ponderous collection of regulations which might be interpreted as hampering the man on the spot. Nothing in the Association's attitude has changed over the years. Although they are all integral parts of the Scout Movement every Scout Group is separately registered and has its own individuality. Because of this their structure, operation and standards must be organised and run along common, clearly defined lines. Even so, Scouting is still a game and if other games have rules so that the players know who wins, Scouting needs its rules so that the game can be played well."

P.O.R. repays study and observation of the Rules saves a lot of time and effort. It is, for example, a

waste of time applying to National Headquarters for approval for a new design of a Group Badge if it has not been submitted to me for approval first - Rule II 35. Also, despite the exhortations of the County Treasurer, one still hears of Groups with bank accounts which are not in the name of the Group or which are not operated by two signatories - Rule I 22 sets out the correct procedure.

This year, no doubt, many overseas expeditions are being planned. I trust that those concerned are familiar with the provisions of Rule II 73. John Havers, A.C.C. (International) must be advised of all proposed visits abroad.

Apart from matters of organisation and procedure though, I always think that it is worth reviewing what badges and awards are currently available for Cub Scouts, Scouts and Venture Scouts. These are all set out in Part II of P.O.R. The variety seems to get wider every year. Do we make the effort to ensure that their existence is known to all our younger members and also make arrangements for them to obtain the necessary knowledge and experience to qualify?

The Entertainers Badge for Cub Scouts and Scouts has been much in my mind in recent weeks. My wife and I have been invited to a number of very good Gang Shows, the most recent being those arranged by 1st Ashted and 7th Epsom. B.P. was a great advocate of acting and generally performing in public. It all helps to instil confidence in youngs and is valuable as an extra on top of the normal training programme.

Adherence to the normal Scouting programme is indeed important whatever "optional extras" are on offer, and that certainly goes for water activities. I was very pleased therefore to note that at the recent inspection of 4th Thames Ditton (Ajax) Sea Scout Group for renewal of Royal Naval recognition, the inspecting officer, Lieutenant Commander P.E. Cressey, R.N., made a point of asking each Scout about his progress with obtaining the Scout Standard, Advanced Scout Standard or Chief Scout's Award according to the length of time each had been in the Troop. Scout training comes first and I was glad to see that renewal of R.N. recognition was eventually recommended. Well done!

GORDON BATES

Leader Training

From: David Barrell

The Seminar on 14th May at Dorking giving leaders of all sections a chance to talk to each other about the place of the Promise and Law in Scouting seems to have attracted the interest of quite a lot of people. If you would like to attend and particularly if you want to have a buffet lunch, please get in touch immediately with Winnie Viner at the address given. Catering arrangements must be finalised by 9th May. If you only wish to attend for part of the day this can be arranged provided you make it clear to Winnie when you contact her.

Details of the Advanced course offered by the county training team are set out, if you are interested in any of them, tell the course leader now so that a provisional reservation can be made. The final timing of the G.S.L. Advanced Course is not yet possible but is likely to be a separate Saturday in November and a

Sunday in December, the object being to give as much flexibility as possible to the participants. Get in touch with me now if you would like more details as soon as the jigsaw of dates has been put together.

Due to a change in demand from Venture Scout Leaders and to enable those who attended this year's Basic Course to complete their advanced training this year we have put the proposed advanced course back to the autumn - please look again at the new dates below.

The A.D.C.s(L.T.) meet at Bentley Copse on Saturday, 7th May at 3 p.m. to discuss among other things the pattern of training courses during the autumn/winter months. If you have not already made clear to your A.D.C. your training requirements, whether in respect of the formal Basic and Advanced Courses or informal local training opportunities, tell him or her now so that something can be done about it.

Courses

SEMINAR

The Promise and Law
What's it All About 14th May

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 20th/22nd &
(residential) 27th/29th May
Worcester Park 18th/19th/22nd/29th
(non-residential) June & 2nd/3rd July
4 days & 2 evenings

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 18th/19th June &
(residential) 1st/3rd, 15/17th July

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 17th/18th September
& 15th/16th October

GROUP SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse & 1/2 October &
elsewhere 2 separate days in
November/December

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

E. Daniel, Flat 7, Barfield Court, Ladbroke Road, Redhill.

R. Wood, 2 Ashley Close, Frimley Green, Camberley.

B. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

D.R. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.

Here and There

Grant Aid

Attention is drawn to the following funds which are available.

SEA SCOUTS ADMIRALTY FUND.

Applications are invited, preferably from R.N. Recognised Groups, for financial assistance towards boats, equipment etc. Application forms available from Peter Lankester, County Grant Aid Adviser.

THE JOHN FORSTER FUND.

This fund is to give assistance to Scouts with their career and could, under certain circumstances, include help for those experiencing difficulty with fees for part time education and associated expenses. Applications to Peter Lankester.

Barn Dance

The Dorking District Jubilee Year Barn Dance will be held at Dorking Halls on Friday, May 13th 1977, 8.00 p.m. until midnight. Licensed Bar provided, dancing will be to a folk group. Admission £1.25 includes a ploughman's supper. Tickets available from Rows Stationers, 34/36, South Street, Dorking Tel. 2046.

50th Anniversary

The 1st West Ewell Group started as the 1st Ewell (West) Group on 4th April, 1928 and is anxious to hear from anyone who can help provide any information of the Group, especially during the period 1928 to 1958. A telephone call to Les Jacques on (01) 393 6122 will be greatly appreciated.

Quartermaster

The County is looking for someone who will be willing to act as County Quartermaster in respect of various items which the County has acquired over the years, in particular, items used for display material. The job includes booking items out to various borrowers, checking the items back in, general maintenance, etc. This may suit a retired Scouter. Anyone who is interested, or anyone who knows anyone who may be interested, please contact the County Secretary.

Special Congratulations

We were delighted to learn of the Award of the Silver Acorn to Simon Pilley in the St. George's Day Awards. Simon was A.C.C. (Scouts) in Surrey before he moved to the County of Cleveland in January, 1972 where he is currently County Commissioner.

Value Added Tax

You may not be aware that certain rules regarding VAT have recently been changed. When VAT was first introduced, any ADDITIONS to buildings were charged at zero rate by a builder or supplier who erected the addition, but if the additions were done by yourself (or members of the Group) you had to pay VAT and there were no means by which the VAT could be recovered. The rules have now been changed and there now is a form obtainable from the local Customs and Excise Office, by which VAT can be reclaimed on all materials used in ADDING TO (not repairing) your home or Group Headquarters. The County Treasurer will give advice if required.

Distribution

Whilst it is understood that all District distributors make sure that "Surrey Scout" and other information get to Groups as quickly as possible, it seems that some Groups are not so good at getting these items to the individual Scouters. What a pity that so much effort by County and District is wasted by some Groups. The date of distribution is always published in "Surrey Scout" and if YOU do not receive it soon afterwards then COMPLAIN. And don't forget your Group Chairman, Secretary and Treasurer, G.S.Ls.

Census Returns and Subscriptions

At the time of going to press, the following Returns had been received:

1. Staines
2. Esher
3. Horley
4. Surrey Heath
5. Banstead

and a cheque in full payment of Headquarter and County subscriptions had been received from:

1. Horley.

Well Done, all those involved and THANK YOU.

Scouts

From Roy D. Wood

I receive a number of District and Group Newsletters which I read with a great deal of interest often quoting from them in discussion and passing on thoughts throughout the County. I never divulge their source so there is no cause for concern and the only reason they are quoted, often without comment, is to create discussion and thinking. Being in the business of the 'printed word' I learnt long ago not to believe everything in print and I can recognise a gentle 'leg pull' when I see one - I ought to, I use the art myself quite a bit! However this time I refer to a Troop report and comment because there appears to be something which needs saying.

"We have appointed x and y as Senior Patrol Leaders to assist the Leaders and to help the Patrol Leaders to settle into their new positions. Scouters A, B and C are taking the boys above Scout Standard and Scouters D and E are taking the boys below Scout Standard"

Perhaps after all I won't comment just offer a

prize for the best paper on these two statements.

County First Aid Competition

Excellent arrangements by Woking District, excellent competition and judging arranged by the St. John's Ambulance Brigade. Unfortunately only 9 Districts entered teams. A further improvement shows in the standard of First Aid but there is still a long way to go. What did shatter me was the number of granny knots tied during the day!

Congratulations to the winners, Woking District, represented by a team from 1st Horsell.

Chief Scout's Award

I have no further information about the Special presentation at Gilwell Park mentioned in February "Scouting". I have started a list of those wishing to attend and will advise them when I receive details. This is a special presentation for Jubilee Year, not to be repeated and those attending will be expected to attend a County Presentation as well.

County Chaplain

From: Barry Anderson

Henry Louis Mencken died on January 28th, 1956, at the age of 75. At the age of 18 he became a journalist, and at one time was as influential in America as Bernard Shaw in Britain, and the greatest living authority on the American language. In his day he skinned everything in America that he thought pretentious, shoddy, pompous and glossily second-rate. He once gave the following advice to Alistair Cooke when he was starting his career as a journalist:

"Never accept a free ticket from a theatre manager, a free ride from the Chamber of Commerce, or a favour from a politician. That way you will find that shaving in the morning can be a relatively agreeable pastime."

He astonished his opponents by being in private so mild, so courteous, preferring, as he said, "an opponent who fights like a gentleman in a duel, to

a sailor cleaning out a waterfront saloon."

In 1948 he had a cerebral thrombosis, which left him paralysed. He made a partial recovery but discovered that his brain had been damaged in that part that synchronizes sight and meaning, - the ability to see, and the ability to make sense of what you see. He could focus on a written page but what he saw was an orderly array of meaningless symbols. He was never able to read or write again. In his last years he sat at home surrounded by an ocean of books, like a castaway sailor, mocked by the one element he had loved and mastered.

He was a lifelong atheist, and towards the end of his life he was challenged by an old opponent to confess what he would do if he discovered there was an afterlife by the simple fact of finding himself in one. He said:

"If I do fetch up beside the Twelve Apostles, I should simply say to them: Gentlemen, I was wrong."

Congratulations

BAR TO THE MEDAL OF MERIT

E.G. Lane G.S.L. 17th Reigate (St. Joseph's)

MEDAL OF MERIT

Gio. P.W. Corno District Service Team Leader,
Runnymede

QUEEN'S SCOUT

Simon Morley 3rd Staines (St. Peter's)
John Elliott 6th Staines (Christ Church)

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

Philip Christmas Royal Grammar School, Guildford
John Cunningham 1st West Byfleet
Stephen Harris 1st West Byfleet
Anthony Hooke 5th Guildford
Mark Wells 8th Woking
Stuart Wingham 1st Chiddingfold

Directory

East Surrey

D.S.T.L. delete E. Mackie

A.D.C. (Scout Fellowship)

A.J. Osborn, 4, Broadbridge Cottages, Broad-
bridge Lane, Smallfield, Horley. Tel. Small-
field 3489

District Water Activities Adviser (Canoeing)

J.T. Monk, 'Gazeley', Mount Pleasant Road,
Lingfield. Tel. 833087

District Water Activities Adviser (Sailing)

J.B. Dearmer, 45, Oaklands, South Godstone.
Tel. 2246

District Mountaineering Adviser

R. Smith, 3, Youngmans, St. Piers Lane, Lingfield.
Tel. 833879

Cage Venture Scout Unit

P.J. Kaye, 'Almos', Holland Road, Hurst Green.
Tel. Oxted 3612.

County Diary

May

27 County A.G.M. Woking

June

2 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking

11 Chief Scout's Award
Certificate Presentation Epsom

13 Finance Committee Leatherhead

16 Water Activities Sub-Committee Walton-on-T

16 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Ashted

24/26 Aquameet Longridge

July

4 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead

10 County Regatta Walton-on-T

14 P. & T. Meeting N. Holmwood

20 County Executive Committee B.-P. House

September

11 Sailing Regatta 'Ajax' HQ

12 Finance Committee Leatherhead

15 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking

15 Water Activities Sub-
Committee Dorking

24/25 Scout Camping Competition Bentley Copse

October

3 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead

4 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead

10 P. & T. Meeting Gt. Bookham

19 County Executive
Committee B.-P. House

Chief Scout's Award

Certificate Presentation

Guildford

December

1 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking

12 Finance Committee Leatherhead

13 Water Activities Sub-
Committee Cuddington

June "Surrey Scout"

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